

Chapter 77 - Why

The lighting inside the bar was dim, and the ear-splitting dance music made it difficult to hear other sounds.

So when she heard that familiar yet cool voice, Feng Yue thought she had misheard or was hallucinating.

But soon reality told her she was not wrong.

That familiar scent broke through the alcohol permeating the bar, instantly overwhelming Feng Yue's entire being. It was only at this moment that she confirmed her suspicion.

The person who had pulled her aside was Yan Lin.

The drunk man who had fallen was helped up and taken away by staff. Feng Yue, with Yan Lin's help, now supported Jiang Ming and stood upright.

"Are you alright?" Yan Lin's voice accurately reached Feng Yue's ears through the noisy dance music.

The alternating light and shadow illuminated Yan Lin's face, and even so, one could clearly see the concern and worry for Feng Yue in her eyes.

Feng Yue frowned and, supporting Jiang Ming, stepped back slightly to distance herself from Yan Lin.

Seeing this, Yan Lin immediately panicked, and her brain, which had been consumed by alcohol, became much clearer.

"No, no, I didn't follow you here—" But as she said this, Yan Lin paused.

She indeed hadn't followed Yan Lin to this bar. She just hadn't gotten over jet lag and wanted to come to the bar for a couple of drinks to help her sleep. She hadn't expected to run into Feng Yue and her cousin here.

But she had followed Feng Yue to Vancouver.

This was an undeniable fact.

Feng Yue didn't have time to deal with Yan Lin right now. She wanted to first handle the disheveled drunk in her arms.

So Feng Yue didn't pay any more attention to Yan Lin and directly supported Jiang Ming as they walked toward the restroom.

Yan Lin followed closely behind the two, watching Feng Yue sway as she supported Jiang Ming, reaching out from behind to protect Feng Yue in case she fell.

It wasn't until the three reached the washbasin area that Feng Yue finally let Jiang Ming lean against the wall.

Feng Yue caught her breath and reached out to get tissues, but after fumbling for a while, she realized she hadn't brought any. Jiang Ming, needless to say, hadn't brought any either.

Helplessly, she turned her gaze to Yan Lin, who was standing guard nearby: "Do you have tissues?"

Yan Lin snapped back to attention, nodded, then fumblingly pulled a pack of tissues from her bag and handed them to Feng Yue: "Here."

"Thank you."

"No problem."

Then the two fell into silence again.

It wasn't until Feng Yue had cleaned up Jiang Ming's wet clothes that she finally exhaled and washed her hands clean.

Looking at Jiang Ming leaning against the wall like she'd lost her mind, Feng Yue showed some reluctance at the thought of having to carry her back to that dark, deafeningly loud booth.

"Could you help me?" Feng Yue asked with an unchanged expression, as if asking a complete stranger for help. "Help me get her to the door, I'll go get my bag."

Her expression showed no change whatsoever, as if she were asking for help from the most ordinary passerby.

Yan Lin nodded dumbly, then reached out to help support Jiang Ming as they walked toward the bar's exit.

Fine snow was falling outside, flake by flake landing on Yan Lin's head as she held the unconscious Jiang Ming in her arms.

Feng Yue had gone inside to get her bag and hadn't come out yet.

When she did come out, she saw Yan Lin standing foolishly under the streetlight, not even thinking to find shelter from the snow.

She had already called Jiang Zhao, who would arrive soon.

She stood at the door looking at the silhouettes of Yan Lin and Jiang Ming, thought for a moment, then turned and went back into the bar. When she came out again, she was holding a black umbrella.

Feng Yue walked to the streetlight and raised the umbrella: "Even if the snow isn't heavy, you should still take shelter."

"Thank you." Yan Lin lowered her eyelashes and quietly shuffled closer to Feng Yue.

Jiang Zhao arrived faster than expected. A black SUV stopped by the roadside, and Jiang Zhao, wearing a black wool coat, jogged over with a thick down jacket in his hands.

Jiang Zhao's gaze quickly swept over Jiang Ming, then he asked Feng Yue, who was only wearing a windbreaker: "Are you alright? I brought you clothes, put them on quickly."

Feng Yue took the coat and put it on. Only then did Jiang Zhao take Jiang Ming from Yan Lin's arms and carry her toward the car.

Feng Yue stuffed the umbrella into Yan Lin's hands and politely bid her farewell: "Thank you for today, I'm leaving now."

Yan Lin stood there dumbly, opening and closing her mouth but not knowing what to say.

Feng Yue didn't care about her—didn't care why she had appeared in Vancouver, didn't care why she had appeared at the bar. Perhaps if she hadn't helped out, Feng Yue wouldn't have wanted to talk to her at all.

Seeing that she was about to open the car door and get in, Yan Lin rushed forward in three quick steps, her exhaled breath turning into white mist that disappeared into the air.

"Ah Yue, could we meet tomorrow to talk? I have something I want to discuss with you, is that okay?"

Feng Yue looked at her, said something, then got into the car and closed the door without hesitation.

Until the vehicle drove away, Yan Lin remained standing there in a daze.

Her ears kept echoing with what Feng Yue had said.

She had said: "But I don't want to meet with you."

—

Since that day when Feng Yue saw Yan Lin at the bar, she never encountered her in the neighborhood again.

Until a week later when her aunt Miller¹ came back and told them that a small villa that had been vacant for years nearby had been bought, she instinctively knew it was Yan Lin's doing.

Sure enough, the next day Yan Lin came to visit as a neighbor, bringing gifts.

Miller had only seen Yan Lin once and naturally wasn't very familiar with her. Yan Lin had probably picked the right time to visit them.

Feng Yue's parents were accompanying her grandparents to Stanley Park², her uncle and the siblings Jiang Zhao and Jiang Ming had all gone to work, leaving only Miller and Feng Yue at home.

Since this area was near Chinatown³, most of the nearby residents were Chinese, so when Miller saw that Yan Lin was also Chinese, she showed her the greatest kindness.

The gift Yan Lin brought wasn't anything very expensive, just a rather exquisite tea set that Miller quite liked.

Miller invited her in and asked Feng Yue to take Yan Lin to the living room to sit while she went to the kitchen to prepare tea and snacks.

Feng Yue didn't want to unnecessarily let Miller know about her relationship with Yan Lin, so she acted as if she wasn't familiar with her.

Yan Lin looked at Feng Yue, who was sitting nearby quietly reading, and her fingers hanging at her sides couldn't help but curl.

Her visit today was incidental—the most important thing was that she wanted to talk to Feng Yue about that bucket list.

But she also understood that the current Feng Yue was unwilling and had no reason to meet with her alone. To put it bluntly, even that bucket list itself had nothing to do with Yan Lin.

But Yan Lin didn't want it to be this way.

In her previous life, Feng Yue had died with endless regrets. She didn't want this second chance at life for Feng Yue to end in premature death like before.

She clearly had a better future ahead of her. They clearly had a better future ahead of them.

The two remained silent for who knows how long.

Yan Lin: "Ah Yue, I..."

Feng Yue glanced at the wall clock and interrupted her: "Miss Yan, my parents will be back for lunch soon. You don't want to run into them, do you?"

Yan Lin pressed her lips together and, seeing no sign that Miller was about to come out of the kitchen, she leaned slightly closer to Feng Yue and lowered her voice: "Ah Yue, I want to talk to you about this."

As she spoke, Yan Lin unfolded the paper she had been keeping in her pocket and displayed it in front of Feng Yue.

Feng Yue only took one look before her expression changed dramatically. She quickly pressed the paper back into Yan Lin's arms, then looked warily toward the kitchen.

Feng Yue's brows furrowed tightly, a sharp light flashing in her eyes, and her fingertips pressed harder against Yan Lin's wrist.

"Where did you get this?"

Yan Lin looked at her baring her fangs like a startled little beast, feeling somewhat uncomfortable, but still sighed and patted Feng Yue's shoulder to signal her to calm down.

How could Feng Yue calm down? This was her biggest secret, a matter of life and death.

She threw down the book on her lap, grabbed Yan Lin's wrist, and pulled her outside, calling out to Miller, who was busy in the kitchen, as they walked.

Feng Yue: "Auntie⁴, the new neighbor wants me to help her with something. We're going over there first!"

Miller hadn't reacted yet. By the time she came out of the kitchen to look, the two had already left.

Feng Yue's expression was grave as she pulled Yan Lin step by step outside.

The busy roadside wasn't a good place to talk, so Yan Lin suggested: "Would you like to come sit at my house?"

Feng Yue's face was stern. After weighing her options for two seconds, she said curtly: "Let's go."

The two didn't say another word until they sat down in Yan Lin's new home.

Yan Lin didn't know how to begin, while Feng Yue was thinking about how to brush her off.

Yan Lin's new home looked quite nice—the kind of place where you could move in immediately with just your luggage. For Yan Lin, this house was just a hotel that looked more like a home.

"Give me back my things." Feng Yue spoke first.

Yan Lin silently placed the paper in Feng Yue's palm. Feng Yue curled her fingers and clutched the paper tightly in her hand without saying a word.

"Ah Yue, can you tell me why you wrote this?"

Yan Lin's voice was gentle, but at this moment, Feng Yue was like a hedgehog that had been stroked the wrong way, with all her spines standing up.

"You're asking me why? I haven't even asked you where you got this thing from. What, has President Yan⁵ changed careers to become a locksmith and started breaking into houses illegally?" Feng Yue looked at her coldly.

Yan Lin was stumped, then helplessly explained to Feng Yue how this paper had come into her hands.

When mentioning Wen Zhen, Yan Lin obviously paused, then continued with a normal expression: "When Wen Zhen saw this paper, she was completely frightened. That's why she had no choice but to find me... We were very worried about you, so I came to Vancouver."

Feng Yue knew that Yan Lin disdained lying and wouldn't lie, so after hearing her explanation, her expression improved considerably.

She also remembered that Wen Zhen had indeed gone to her house to get books that day, and she had previously tucked this paper inside one of the books.

Wen Zhen could very well have seen it, and when Feng Yue had called her that day, her tone had indeed been somewhat abnormal.

Wen Zhen must have seen the contents of this paper at that time.

Feng Yue was annoyed at her own carelessness, but also grateful that she hadn't written anything more outrageous on this paper.

However, she hadn't expected Yan Lin's reaction to be so strong, even personally chasing her to Vancouver.

The time she had written on the bucket list was the time of her death in her previous life. Logically, Yan Lin should understand why she wrote this time.

But from her current expression, she seemed completely unable to understand why she would write such a thing.

Feng Yue looked at her confused expression, pretending to care about herself, and a gloomy anger rose in her heart.

"What are you pretending for, Yan Lin? Others might not know why I wrote this, but how could you not know? Don't you know what day May 4th is? Or have you simply forgotten? That's right, I'm just cannon fodder⁶ destined to die, destined to make way for you all. You don't need to remember either."

"You ask me why I wrote this? Of course it's to properly plan the limited days I have left to live!"

"My death is irreversible, so I can only make the most of my limited life."

Footnotes:

1. **Miller:** Feng Yue's aunt-in-law, Jiang Pingrui's wife, who is not Chinese and speaks English.
2. **Stanley Park:** A famous large urban park in Vancouver, British Columbia, Canada, popular with tourists and locals.
3. **Chinatown:** A district in Vancouver with a large Chinese population and many Chinese businesses and restaurants.
4. **Auntie (舅妈):** Specifically refers to the wife of one's maternal uncle. Feng Yue is addressing Miller.
5. **President Yan (严总):** A formal way of addressing Yan Lin by her corporate title, showing distance and coldness.
6. **Cannon fodder (炮灰):** A term originally from military contexts, now commonly used in fiction to describe characters who exist only to die or suffer for the plot, often to make way for main characters.

